

allows players with higher initiatives to plan their characters' actions based on what slower characters are going to do. These declarations of intent can include stating that your character delays her action to see what someone else does. Also, if your character is planning on performing multiple actions in this action turn, you must declare this now. You are free to choose any action that can be performed in one turn — using a cantrip, picking a pocket, charging at someone and hacking at them with your broadsword or scrambling into a car and driving away at high speed. You can also yield your action and wait to see what everyone else does first. Doing this allows characters with lower initiative scores to act first. Your character can still act at the end of the turn. If everyone yields their action, then the turn passes without anything happening.

Initiative Complications

Several exceptions can occur to the order of initiative. If you delay your character's action, you can have her act at any point later in the turn. If she acts on the same initiative number as another character, the character with the highest initiative rating goes first. You can also abort your character's planned action and perform a defensive action as long as you have at least one action remaining in the turn (see **Aborting Actions**). Finally, any additional actions gained through cantrips or splitting dice pools occur at the end of the turn. Once again, these end of turn actions occur in the order of the characters' initiative rating.

Phase Two: Attack

In addition to using cantrips and other supernatural or indirect means of attack, characters can physically attack each other in one of several different ways. Unless otherwise stated, most attacks are made versus difficulty 6. See the individual weapon descriptions and descriptions of specific combat maneuvers for further information on difficulties. Options for physical attacks include:

- ⑤ Characters making a close combat attack using their fists, feet, claws, or any other sort of unarmed attack use Dexterity + Brawl.
- ⑤ Close combat attacks made using any sort of hand-to-hand weapon like a sword, axe, or length of pipe use Dexterity + Melee.
- ⑤ Ranged combat attacks made using guns, bows, or crossbows use Dexterity + Firearms.
- ⑤ Ranged combat attacks made using thrown weapons, like hurled rocks, boomerangs, or thrown knives use Dexterity + Athletics.

Combat Maneuvers

Characters have many options in combat other than making a simple attack. These maneuvers allow for both more dramatic, and often more effective, combat. Unless described otherwise, each of these maneuvers requires one action to perform.

General Maneuvers

The following maneuvers can be used with all forms of attack or defense.

Aborting Actions: You can abandon the action you stated for your character during the initiative phase and instead perform a defensive maneuver at any time during a turn. However, you can only choose this option if you have at least one action remaining in that turn. You can also only abort an action to perform a block, dodge, or parry.

Aborting an action requires effort. To perform this maneuver, you must either make a successful Willpower roll (difficulty 6) or spend a point of Willpower. Rolling or spending Willpower to succeed at aborting an action are reflexive actions and do not count as any of your character's actions for the turn. See **Defensive Maneuvers** for descriptions of block, dodge, and parry. If your character fails her Willpower roll, she must perform her originally declared action, unless she spends a point of Willpower.

Ambush: An ambush is a surprise attack where the attacker attempts to attack her target suddenly and without warning so the target is unable to defend himself. Performing this maneuver requires the attacker's player to roll Dexterity + Stealth in a resisted roll against her target's Perception + Alertness. If the attacker wins, she can perform a single free attack against her target, the target cannot perform any sort of defensive maneuver (unless permitted by an active cantrip or some other supernatural means), and the target cannot even abort a previous action to perform a defensive maneuver. In addition, the attacker can add any additional successes from the resisted roll to her attack roll. On a tie, the attacker still attacks first, but the target can perform defensive maneuvers normally. If the defender wins the contest, then he spots the ambush just before it happens and both parties roll initiative normally.

Flank and Rear Attacks: Attacking a character from their flank gives the attacker one additional die for her attack roll. Attacking a character from behind adds two additional dice to the attacker's roll.

Movement: Characters can move up to half their running distance (see **Movement**, p. 252) in a turn and still act normally. Moving further than this in one turn counts as an automatic action. Performing maneuvers like climbing, jumping, or tumbling may count as separate actions, depending on their complexity.

Targeting: Aiming for a specific location incurs an added difficulty, but can be used to bypass armor or cover, increase damage, or perform daring feats like shooting a weapon out of someone's hand. Depending upon the nature of the attack and the target, the attack may have effects other than increased difficulty and damage. Characters can target during both close combat and ranged attacks.

Target Size	Added Difficulty	Extra Damage Dice	Examples
Medium	+1	0	arm, briefcase
Small	+2	+1	hand, head, dagger
Precise	+3	+2	eye, heart, lock

Two Weapon Use: Characters who are especially skilled and daring can attempt to use two weapons at once, wielding one in each hand. This maneuver only works for suitable